

Pan-Seared Salmon with Lemon Caper Butter (Variation 11)

Tags: seafood, salmon, dinner, quick, low-carb, gluten-free | Prep: 10 min | Cook: 15 min | Serves: 12

Ingredients

- 12 salmon fillets (180 g each), skin on
- 4.5 tsp fine salt
- 3 tsp black pepper
- 6 tbsp olive oil
- 9 tbsp unsalted butter
- 12 garlic cloves, thinly sliced
- 9 tbsp capers, drained
- Juice of 4.5 lemons
- 6 tbsp fresh basil, chopped
- Lemon wedges to serve

Method

1. Pat salmon fillets completely dry. Season flesh and skin sides with salt and pepper.
2. Heat oil in a large non-stick or stainless skillet over medium-high heat until shimmering.
3. Place salmon skin-side down. Press gently for 10 seconds with a spatula to prevent curling.
4. Cook undisturbed for 5–7 minutes until skin is crisp and golden. The flesh should be opaque halfway up the side.
5. Flip and cook for a further 2–3 minutes for medium (slightly translucent in the centre).
6. Remove salmon and set aside. Reduce heat to medium.
7. Add butter to the pan. Once melted, add garlic and cook 1 minute until golden.
8. Add capers and cook 30 seconds. Remove pan from heat and add lemon juice and parsley.
9. Pour butter sauce over salmon. Serve with lemon wedges.

Chef Tips

- Starting skin-side down and not moving the salmon allows the skin to crisp completely.
- Do not overcook — salmon is best medium (slightly translucent in the very centre).
- Bring salmon to room temperature for 15 minutes before cooking for even heat penetration.